

> EXPLANATIONS

1. (a) 'Firstly' is used to introduce a first point or reason. It does not make sense in the given sentence. So, we would use 'First' instead of 'Firstly'.
2. (c) 'Suddenly stop' in the sentence does not make sense. Hence, we would change it to 'sudden stop' to make the sentence meaningful.
3. (b) 'Leisure' as an adjective and does not make sense in the sentence. It should be changed to its adverb form i.e. 'leisurely'.
4. (b) 'Thoroughly cleaning' is incorrect. It should be 'thorough cleaning'.
5. (b) 'Much' is used in comparative degree and 'very' is used in positive degree. So, we should use 'very' in place of 'much' in the given sentence.
6. (d) The sentence is correct.
7. (c) 'Different' in the sentence does not convey the right meaning of the sentence. It must be changed to 'differently'.
8. (c) 'Decided' is incorrect and does not make sense with the sentence. It should be changed to its adverb form 'decidedly'.
9. (a) 'Careful' in the given sentence should be changed to 'carefully' to convey the right meaning of the sentence.
10. (b) 'Direct' means straight and 'directly' means 'at once'. Hence, we would use 'direct' in the sentence instead of 'directly'.
11. (d) The sentence is correct.
12. (c) 'Hardly won freedom' means 'negligibly won freedom' and does not make sense in the sentence. It should be changed to 'hard won freedom'.
13. (b) 'Enough kind' does not make sense. It should be changed to 'kind enough'.
14. (b) 'Than' used in the sentence is incorrect. It should be changed to 'but'.
15. (b) 'Anyone' should be replaced by 'someone' to make the sentence meaningful.
16. (b) 'Too' and 'much' are not used together. It should be 'too heavy'.
17. (b) 'More' should be used after 'esteem' to make the sentence meaningful.
18. (c) 'Never' in the given sentence should be replaced by 'did not' to make the sentence meaningful.
19. (c) 'Too' should be replaced by 'very' to make the sentence grammatically correct.
20. (a) 'Did not know' should be removed and 'knew' should be added after 'hardly' to correct the sentence.
21. (b) 'Very quicker' should be replaced by 'quicker' to make the sentence correct.
22. (a) 'Sure' needs to be changed to its adverb form 'surely' to make the sentence correct.
23. (b) 'Miser' needs to be changed to 'miserly' to make the sentence grammatically correct.
24. (c) 'So' needs to be replaced by 'very' to correct the sentence.
25. (b) 'Lately' does not convey the right meaning. It should be changed to 'late'.
26. (c) 'Soundly slept' needs to be changed to 'slept soundly' to make the sentence meaningful.
27. (a) As per the rule, two negative words cannot be used together in a sentence. In the given sentence, 'barely' and 'nothing' are negative words. So, we would replace 'nothing' by 'anything'.
28. (a) 'Too' needs to be replaced by 'very' to make the sentence grammatically correct.
29. (a) 'Quickly' does not make sense. So, we replace it by its adjective form i.e. 'quick'.
30. (d) No error.

CONJUNCTIONS

A conjunction is a part of speech that connects words, phrases, clauses or sentences.

e.g. - and, but, while, though, although, lest etc.

Rules of Conjunctions

- 'Scarcely' and 'Hardly' should be followed by when and not by than.
e.g. - *Scarcely* had I started for the institute, *when* / ~~than~~ the rain started.
- *Hardly* had he arrived, *when* he had to leave again.
- 'No sooner' is followed by than and not by when.
e.g. - *No sooner* had I left, *than* / ~~when~~ the rain started.
- *No sooner* did he arrive, ~~then~~ / *than* he had to leave.
- 'Seldom or never' and 'seldom if ever' are both correct, but 'seldom or ever' is incorrect.
e.g. - He *seldom or never* goes to see movies in a theatre.
- 'Either-or', 'Neither-nor', 'not only-but also', 'both-and', 'whether-or' etc., should be followed by the same parts of speech or of the same function.
e.g. - He *neither* agreed to my proposal *nor* to his. (X)
- He agreed *neither* to my proposal *nor* to his. (✓)
- *Neither* he helps his mother by money *nor* by other means. (X)
- He helps his mother *neither* by money *nor* by other means. (✓)
- He helps his mother *not only* by money *but also* by other means. (✓)
- The conjunctions 'though' (or although) and 'but' do the work of setting one statement against another by way of oppositions or contrast and therefore, the correlative of 'though' is 'yet' or a comma (,).
e.g. - *Though* he worked hard *yet* he could not top the class.
- After the adjective 'other' (which is regarded as a kind of comparative), the only word that can be correctly used for contrasting one thing with another is 'than'. The prepositions *from*, *but*, *except* in such a connection are wrong.
e.g. - He had no *other* option ~~but~~ / *than* to fight.
- He had *another* reason ~~from~~ / *than* what he professed.
- She had no other claim to the post ~~except~~ / *than* her good looks.
- Conjunction 'that' is not used in the following cases
(a) Direct narration.
e.g. - He said, "I am smart".
(b) Indirect speech, if the sentence is interrogative.
e.g. - He asked who he was.
- In a 'not only.....but also' sentence, the verb should agree with the noun or pronoun mentioned second, because this is the part being emphasised.
e.g. - *Not only* the teacher *but also* the students are enjoying themselves.
- 'Such as' is used to denote a category, whereas 'such that' emphasises the degree of something by mentioning its consequences.
e.g. - Yuvraj played *such* an innings *as* played by the best batsman.
- Yuvraj played *such* an innings *that* it took the match away from the opposition.
- 'Both' is followed by *and* not by *as well as*. Besides, both has positive sense and cannot be used in negative sentences.
e.g. - *Both* Amit ~~as well as~~ / *and* his friends are coming.
- *Both* Amit *and* his friends are *not* coming. (X)
- *Neither* Amit nor his friends are coming. (✓)
- 'Unless' means if not and therefore, it should not be used in a sentence or clause which is already negative.
e.g. - *Unless* you *do not* work hard, you will fail. (X)
- *Unless* you work hard, you will fail. (✓)
- 'Lest' expresses a negative sense and therefore cannot be used with not. 'Should' is always used with 'lest'.
e.g. - Walk steadily, *lest* you should *not* fall. (X)
- Walk steadily, *lest* you should fall. (✓)
- When 'suppose' is used in the beginning of a sentence to denote a command or a request, it is not followed by *if*.
e.g. - *Suppose if* you are caught, what will happen to your parents? (X)
- *Suppose you* are caught, what will happen to your parents? (✓)
- Avoid the error of using 'than' for 'from' after the adjective *different*.
e.g. - He took a different role ~~than~~ / *from* the ones he has been doing for long.
- 'Nothing else' should be followed by *but*, not by *than*.
e.g. - It is nothing else ~~but/than~~ your carelessness, that you have failed in the exam.
- The use of Present tense after *as if* and *as though* should be avoided. [Subjunctive Mood].
e.g. - He looks as if he *suspects* something. (X)
- He looks as if he *suspected* something. (✓)

SPOTTING THE ERRORS **SET 7**
 ERRORS OF CONJUNCTION

Directions (Q. Nos. 1-30) Which part of the given sentences has an error? In case, there is no error, choose option (d).

1. Although they listen to me (a)/ but their actions (b)/ prove otherwise. (c)/ No error (d)
2. He treats (a)/ us as (b)/ slaves. (c)/ No error (d)
3. Most of the girls are doing (a)/ their post graduation because (b)/ they may get good husbands. (c)/ No error (d)
4. Such was his pronunciation (a)/ as (b)/ I could not understand him. (c)/ No error (d)
5. He asked (a)/ that who (b)/ I was. (c)/ No error (d)
6. I am interested (a)/ in such books (b)/ that are interesting. (c)/ No error (d)
7. Each member of the alliance (a)/ agrees to take such action (b)/ that it deems necessary. (c)/ No error (d)
8. She looked at him (a)/ in such distress (b)/ as he had to look away. (c)/ No error (d)
9. This film is interesting (a)/ and the previous one (b)/ was boring. (c)/ No error (d)
10. It is difficult to know (a)/ whether (b)/ you are selected or not. (c)/ No error (d)
11. He has no chance (a)/ than to start (b)/ his own business. (c)/ No error. (d)
12. They had hardly finished (a)/ their meals that at once (b)/ they resumed their duty. (c)/ No error (d)
13. I don't know whether (a)/ Raj is equally (b)/ good as Vimal. (c)/ No error (d)
14. He (a)/ will return (b)/ on either Monday or Tuesday. (c)/ No error (d)
15. He is (a)/ not honest and not (b)/ truthful. (c)/ No error (d)
16. He has no other business (a)/ but to play (b)/ with computers. (c)/ No error (d)
17. Be smart (a)/ not only in dress (b)/ and also in action. (c)/ No error (d)
18. Hardly had I reached the airport (a)/ where I learned about (b)/ the powerful bomb explosion. (c)/ No error (d)
19. My book has been missing (a)/ from my room (b)/ till yesterday. (c)/ No error (d)
20. The manager of the bank was busy; (a)/ so he asked them to come and see him (b)/ between two to three in the afternoon. (c)/ No error (d)
21. No sooner did the Sun set (a)/ than we had ours dinner (b)/ and went to sleep. (c)/ No error (d)
22. Gunjan asked me (a)/ what was (b)/ the time. (c)/ No error (d)
23. Rohit took a different route (a)/ than the one (b)/ he usually takes for going to office. (c)/ No error (d)
24. Komal looks as if (a)/ she wants (b)/ to go home. (c)/ No error (d)
25. What would you do (a)/ if you were (b)/ marooned on an island? (c)/ No error (d)
26. Both Nilakshi (a)/ as well as Shivani (b)/ are going to school. (c)/ No error (d)
27. Koel is not only (a)/ lazy but also (b)/ insane. (c)/ No error (d)
28. Rakshit seldom (a)/ or ever (b)/ goes to play outside. (c)/ No error (d)
29. Priya is fair (a)/ but her child (b)/ are dark coloured. (c)/ No error (d)
30. Simran had (a)/ another reason to declare her assets (b)/ from what she said. (c)/ No error (d)

 EXPLANATIONS

1. (b) The correlative of 'Although' is 'yet' and not 'but'. Hence, we should remove 'but' and use 'yet' in place of it.
2. (d) The sentence is correct.
3. (b) As the sentence starts with 'Most of', 'because' will not be used. We would replace it by 'so that'.
4. (b) As per the rule, 'such...that' is used for mentioning consequences. Hence, we would use 'that' in place of 'as'.
5. (b) As per the rule, 'that' is not used in Indirect speech if the sentence is interrogative. Hence, we would remove 'that' from the sentence.
6. (b) The conjunction 'such' is not needed in the sentence. We need to delete it from the sentence.
7. (d) The sentence is correct.
8. (c) In the given sentence, 'that' would be used in place of 'as'. (For explanation refer to Ans. 4)
9. (b) As a comparison is made in the given sentence, we would use 'but' in place of 'and'.
10. (d) The sentence is correct.
11. (b) We would use 'but' in place of 'than' as 'but' is used for the work of setting one statement ('He has no chance') against another ('to start his own business').
12. (b) 'That at once' needs to be deleted from the sentence and should be replaced by 'when'.

13. (b) In the given sentence, 'as' should be used in place of 'equally' as 'equally' is an adverb.
14. (c) 'on either' is not the correct usage. As per the rule 'Either ...or' should be followed by same parts of speech. Hence, the sentence should be : 'He will return either on Monday or on Tuesday.'
15. (b) Instead of using 'not' two times in the given sentence, we should use 'neither...nor'. So, part (b) would become 'neither honest nor'.
16. (b) As per the rule, after 'other' the only words that can be correctly used for contrasting one thing with another is 'than'. Hence, we should use 'than' in place of 'but'.
17. (c) The correct usage is 'not only ...but also'. Hence, we would use 'but' in place of 'and'.
18. (b) As per the rule, 'hardly' should be followed by 'when'. Hence, we would use 'when' in place of 'where'.
19. (c) 'Till' does not make sense in the sentence. It should be changed to 'since'.
20. (c) 'Between' takes 'and' and not 'to'. So, we would replace 'to' by 'and' in the sentence.
21. (b) 'Ours' should be replaced by 'our' to make the sentence correct.
22. (d) No error
23. (b) 'Than' should be replaced by 'from' to make the sentence correct.
24. (b) As per the rule, the use of present tense should be avoided after 'as if'. Hence, we should change 'wants' to 'wanted' to make the sentence correct.
25. (d) No error
26. (b) As per the rule, 'both' is followed by 'and' and not by 'as well as'. So, we would replace 'as well as' by 'and' to make the sentence correct.
27. (d) No error
28. (b) Usage of 'seldom or ever' is incorrect.
29. (c) As 'child' is singular, we would replace 'are' by 'is' to make the sentence correct.
30. (c) As per the rule, 'from' should not be used with 'another'. So, we would replace it by 'than' to correct the sentence.

PREPOSITION

Preposition is a word that connects a noun, pronoun to another word, especially to a verb, another noun or an adjective.

Some Important Prepositions

1. 'In' is used for bigger places (towns, cities, countries) while 'at' is used for smaller places.
e.g. - I live *at* Shastri Nagar in Meerut.
2. **In / Into** 'In' is used in speaking of things at rest. 'Into' is used in speaking of things in motion.
e.g. - He is shopping *in* the market.
- He jumped *into* the well.
- He is falling *in* love.
- He is *in* the office.
- The snake crawled *into* the hole.
- The cup broke-off *into* a hundred pieces.
3. 'On' denotes position, 'upon' denotes movement.
e.g. - The cat is *on* the table.
- The cat pounced *upon* the mouse.
4. 'With' denotes the 'instrument' and 'by' denotes the 'agent'.
e.g. - The letter was written *by* him *with* his pen.
- The music was generated *by* / *with* a guitar.
- The murder was committed *by* him *with* a pistol.
- The ball was hit *by* the batsman *with* his bat.
5. 'Ago' refers to past time while 'before' denotes precedence between two events.
e.g. - Long *ago*, there was a king named Rama.
6. 'Above' and 'below' merely denote position while 'over' and 'under' also carry a sense of covering or movement.
e.g. - We live *below* the roof.
- Sky is *above* us.
- Train is running *under* the bridge.
- The train is standing *below* the bridge.
- The bird is flying *over* the pond.
- A wire is passing *above* the building.
- I was wearing two sweaters *under* the jacket.
- 'Under' is used before a noun to indicate that a person or thing is being affected by something or is going through a particular process.
e.g.
- I'm rarely *under* pressure and my co-workers are always nice to me.
- 'Under' can mean junior in ranks.
e.g. - He is *under* me.
- If something happens 'under' a particular person or government, it happens when that person or government is in power.
e.g. - There will be no new taxes *under* his leadership.

- Ram existed *before* Mahabharata was fought.
- He came *before* me.
- The train arrived *before* the scheduled time.
- India achieved independence 69 years *ago*.

- If someone does something 'under' a particular name, he uses that name instead of his real name.
e.g. - The patient was registered *under* a false name.
 - 'Beneath' has the same meaning as 'under', but it is better to use it for abstract meanings.
e.g. - *Beneath* the festive mood, there is an underlying apprehension.
- Everybody thought that she was marrying *beneath* her.
- Many find themselves having to take jobs far *beneath* them.
7. Difference between 'on time', 'in time' and 'in good time'.
- 'On time' signifies absolutely right time, neither before nor after.
e.g. - The flight is *on time*.
 - 'In time' means you are not late for the event.
e.g. - I arrived just *in time* for my flight.
 - 'In good time' means with comfortable margin.
e.g. - I arrived at the airport *in good time*.
8. Difference between at the beginning/at the end and in the beginning/in the end
- 'At the beginning' means literally at the beginning.
e.g. - India scored fast *at the beginning* of the match.
 - 'At the end' means literally at the end.
e.g. - *At the end* of the book, you'll find the bibliography.
 - 'In the beginning' (or at first) means in the early stage. It implies that later there was a change.
e.g. - Sachin was nervous *in the beginning*, later he settled down.
 - 'In the end' (or at last) means eventually/after sometime.
e.g. - At first he was scared, but *in the end* he started enjoying.
9. No preposition is placed after the following verbs when they are used in active voice. Order, request, reach, attack, resemble, emphasise, accompany, discuss, investigate, comprise, enter (come into), flee (a place), join, affect, board, etc.
- e.g. - Our forces attacked ~~on~~ the enemy fort.
 - We reached ~~at~~ the station on time.
 - We ordered ~~for~~ a cup of tea.
 - He resembles ~~to~~ his father.
 - He accompanies ~~with~~ her wherever she goes.
 - The police are investigating ~~into~~ the case.
 - The teacher emphasised ~~on~~ morality.
 - I don't want to discuss ~~about~~ the problem with you.
10. Omit 'to' after verb of communication such as advise, tell, ask, beg, command, encourage, request, inform, order.
- e.g. - I advised ~~to~~ him to study hard.
 - I commanded ~~to~~ him to leave.
 - I ordered ~~to~~ him to bring me something to eat.
11. 'Till' is used in particular time while 'until' is used for indefinite time.
- Only 'until' is used at the starting of a sentence.
- e.g. - We shall work *until* we fell down.
 - We shall work *till* sunset.
 - ~~Till~~ / *Until* 30, he was a bachelor.
12. 'Till' is used for time while 'upto' for place.
- e.g. - We shall work *till* 5 pm.
 - We walked ~~till~~/*upto* the station.
13. The same preposition should not be used with two words unless it is appropriate to each of them.
- e.g. - It is different and inferior *to* the other. (X)
 - It is different *from* and inferior *to* the other. (✓)
 - Her dress does not add but detract *from* her appearance. (X)
 - Her dress does not add *to* but detracts *from* her appearance. (✓)
14. 'Since' and 'from' are used before a noun or phrase denoting some point of time but whereas 'since' is preceded by a verb in some perfect tense, 'from' is used with other tenses except the perfect tense. *For* refers to a period of time, not to a point of time, and should not be replaced by *since* or *from*.
- e.g. - I haven't done anything *since* yesterday.
 - He has been here *since* nine o'clock.
 - I started my shop *from* 1st January.
 - I shall start work *from* July.
 - He will join the office *from* tomorrow.
 - I have been practising *for* ten days.
15. Regarding the phrases of time, *morning*, *afternoon* and *evening* are preceded by the preposition 'in' whereas *dawn*, *daybreak*, *noon*, *midday* and *midnight* are preceded by the preposition 'at'. Besides, when these time phrases are qualified by 'last' or 'next', they are not preceded by any preposition.
- e.g. - I like to roam around *in* the evening.
 - I'll see you *at* night.
 - The sun is hottest *at* midday.
 - I met him *last* evening.
16. Across / Through
- e.g. - Walk *across* a road and pass *through* a tunnel.